

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect (links to module 4).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auśadhi* (IAST: auśadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Recall doṣa framework (Module 4).** Vāta = motion, Pitta = transformation, Kapha = structure.
2. **Herb classification by doṣa effect.** From Caraka *Sūtrasthāna* 26:
 - **Heating / Pitta-aggravating** (use with care if pitta-dominant): ginger, ajwain, hot pepper.
 - **Cooling / Pitta-pacifying** (good for hot conditions): mint, fennel.
 - **Drying / Kapha-pacifying** (good for congestion): turmeric, neem.
 - **Lubricating / Vāta-pacifying** (good for dryness): ghee-based preparations.
3. **Maps onto modern thermoregulation.** Heating herbs (ginger, ajwain) often increase metabolic rate slightly. Cooling herbs (mint via TRPM8) provide perceptual cooling. The mapping is empirically observed, not purely conceptual.
4. **Worked example.** “*If someone has a vāta imbalance — dry skin, restless sleep — which of our six herbs would Āyurveda recommend?*” (Avoid the very dry/cold ones. Ginger in moderate amounts; ghee-based ginger tea.)
5. **Safety reminder.** This is wellness lens, NOT diagnosis. Don’t prescribe based on doṣa lens; consult a qualified practitioner.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Herbs and the Doṣas.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).